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Trial casts light on postpartum psychosis

Effective treatments exist but too few doctors know about them, experts say

By Sarah Rahal and Jason Laughlin
GLOBE STAFF

Lindsay Clancy's defense in her triple-murder trial hinges on a dangerous and often misdiagnosed condition that afflicts a small minority of birth mothers: postpartum psychosis. She and her lawyers argue that her mental state left her unable to distinguish right from wrong when she strangled her three children and attempted to kill herself in January

2023. The prosecution does not dispute she was mentally ill but asserts the murders were intentional and premeditated.

Regardless of the verdict, perinatal mental health specialists say a key message is getting lost: postpartum psychosis, when properly and promptly diagnosed, is treatable.

"With treatment, most women recover completely and regain their previous level of functioning," said Dr. Uruj Haider, director of the Massachusetts Child Psychiatry Access

Clancy case

Psychiatrist to face defense questioning as trial resumes. **B1.**

Program. "I think that's very important to emphasize."

A 2017 study in the Journal of Clinical Psychiatry found 88 percent of women with postpartum psychosis had returned to work and routine household responsibilities within nine months. Another study found that hospitalization and treatment with benzodiazepines such as Ativan, antipsychotics, and lithium resulted in remission in 98 percent of patients.

Roughly one to two out of every

1,000 birth mothers experiences postpartum psychosis, a medical emergency that develops within days or weeks after delivery. Broadly speaking, that translates into something between hundreds of cases a year in the US to as many as 9,400.

Unlike the "baby blues" or postpartum depression, the illness can cause delusions, hallucinations, paranoia, profound confusion, and a break from reality. People with the condition fall into depressive or manic subtypes, or a third that presents as a mix of both. Patients with depressive symptoms account for 41 percent of all postpartum psychosis **PSYCHOSIS, Page A10**

Rents fall across US, but not in Boston

More homes and weaker economy help other cities, but supply still tight here

By Andrew Brinker
GLOBE STAFF

Something strange has been happening this year in Los Angeles, San Diego, Washington, D.C., and Denver: In some of the nation's most expensive places to live, rents have fallen, offering residents a rare reprieve.

Not in Boston.

For all the challenges facing Boston's economy right now — cuts at universities and research labs, sluggish job growth, people moving away — rents both in the city and the broader metropolitan area have defied economic gravity, either rising modestly or remaining flat year over year, depending on which numbers you look at. And while other markets have seen an influx of new construction driving rents downward, that hasn't been nearly as much the case here.

In other words, while rents fall elsewhere, even in higher-cost cities where prices have historically been stubborn, Boston's housing market is so out of whack that it's in a class largely by itself.

"There are two big factors at work here: People really want to live in Boston, and the Boston area has one of the largest housing shortages in the country," said Adam Guren, an associate professor **RENTS, Page A7**



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

Passengers boarded an inbound Blue Line train at Airport Station. Electrical problems have troubled the line.

Once stellar, this line is now giving T riders the blues

That train to and from Wonderland has folks wondering: Will we get there?

By Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF

The Blue Line, believe it or not, was a "huge part" of why Jennifer Scholl opted to move to East Boston. When she lived near Boston College, she envied how quickly it ran and trusted it would dependably deliver her to work at Salem State University.

But here Scholl was on Monday evening, stuck on a train crawling toward the Orient Heights Station. "Signal issues" had flared

up again, a T driver announced; she would be late to the gym.

"Sometimes," Scholl said, "*this* happens."

This is an unfortunate new norm for the Blue Line. Once the darling of a beleaguered system for its reliable service, the six-mile track between downtown Boston and Revere has been hamstrung by persistent problems with overhead wires and the electrical power system. Passengers have been diverted from stalled trains at least four times this sum-

mer. A small fire broke out in July. And one rider escorted from a train Monday told a local television station they saw a "shower of sparks" and smelled "burning metal" from a downed cable.

The interruptions are erratic, but not infrequent: An analysis of T data by the transit advocacy group TransitMatters found the Blue Line met only 75 percent of its scheduled service in July, the lowest amount since

BLUE LINE, Page A10

Insiders, outsiders, and a combo

Sixth District Democrats seek to define themselves — and their divided party

By Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

One candidate is all but paying for his campaign out of his own pocket, saying it's proof he's a "political outsider" not focused on pleasing "insiders." Another, conversely, embraces his insider experience, going so far as to showcase a framed picture of former president Joe Biden in his home. Still a third is pitching herself as a bit of both.

The six Democrats vying in the crowded primary for the Sixth Congressional District aren't only figuring out how to grab attention and improve their poll positioning ahead of the Sept. 1 vote. They're also experimenting with messaging in a midterm election that's equal parts a referendum on President Trump and a focus group for revitaliz-

CAMPAIGN, Page A7

DON NELSON 1940-2026

From Celtics stalwart to top coach

To Garden fans, Hall of Famer will always be 'Nellie'

By John Powers
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Don Nelson, who won five championships as a versatile player for the Celtics before becoming an innovative Hall of Fame coach for four NBA clubs, died Sunday at 86, his family said.

His health deteriorated after



FRANK O'BRIEN/GLOBE STAFF

Mr. Nelson, shown in 1978, won 1,335 games as an NBA coach.

a stroke about three weeks ago, The New York Times reported, citing his granddaughter Christie Nelson Armstrong.

Mr. Nelson, who spent 11 seasons with Boston after Los Angeles discarded him and another 31 directing from the sidelines, was involved with basketball for nearly a half-century.

"Can you imagine doing something that you love the most in the entire world and doing it for your entire life and **NELSON, Page C9**



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

MOON DANCE

Members of Boston Chinese Dance waited in the shade for their moment to perform at the 56th annual August Moon Festival Sunday in Boston. **B1.**

The Israeli government rejected a proposal backed by the Trump administration aimed at disarming the Palestinian militant group Hamas in the Gaza Strip. **A3.**

Five years after the pandemic decimated health clubs, the in-

dustry has come roaring back to a point where many owners say they are on the verge of turning potential applicants away. **D1.**

Boston University becomes the latest institution in the region to offer a financial aid package

that covers tuition for students whose families are middle-income. **B1.**

A businessman with legal troubles is one of the largest funders of a cryptocurrency company linked to the Trump family. **D1.**



Full of hot air

Monday: Hazy and hot. High 89-94, low 71-76.

Tuesday: Much the same. Sunrise, 5:46. Sunset, 7:52. Weather and comics, **C4-5.** Obituaries, **C4-5.**

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